



Title: Comfort in Work

Duration: 8 weeks

Target Audience: Participants from (Administrative Staff from University)

Department: (Integrative Health Center)

Facilitator: Dr.Hind Alshareef/ Dr.Karima Abdelhaleem

Delivery Mode: In-person sessions with practical exercise demonstrations + Q&A

Report Date:

Executive Summary

This report documents an 8-week workshop designed to improve participants' musculoskeletal health, posture habits, daily movement patterns, sleep ergonomics, and nutrition awareness. The program combined evidence-based education with hands-on daily exercise practice and introductory surface anatomy to help participants understand their bodies and apply safe movement strategies at work, during commuting, and at home.

A pre- and post-workshop questionnaire was used to evaluate baseline needs, track knowledge gain, and capture changes in self-reported pain, posture awareness, exercise adherence, and lifestyle behaviors. Overall, participants reported improved posture awareness, better ability to manage day-to-day musculoskeletal discomfort, increased confidence in performing daily exercises, and stronger understanding of how nutrition supports whole-body health.

Background and Rationale

Musculoskeletal (MSK) discomfort—especially in the neck, shoulders, back, and knees—is increasingly common due to prolonged sitting, repetitive tasks, poor ergonomics, low physical activity, and inadequate recovery (sleep). These issues can reduce quality of life, productivity, and participation in daily activities.

This workshop was developed to provide participants with practical skills to:

- Adopt correct posture during sitting, standing, walking, and sleeping
- Reduce MSK strain throughout the day using simple, repeatable strategies
- Understand the role of nutrition in tissue health, energy, and recovery
- Perform targeted daily exercises safely and consistently
- Gain foundational knowledge of surface anatomy and key muscle groups to support body awareness and injury prevention

Objectives

By the end of the program, participants were expected to:

1. Demonstrate correct posture principles for daily activities (sitting/standing/walking/sleeping).
2. Apply risk-reduction strategies to avoid MSK pain during work and routine tasks.
3. Explain key nutrition principles that support musculoskeletal and general health.
4. Perform a structured set of daily exercises for major body regions with correct form.
5. Identify major superficial muscles and anatomical landmarks relevant to posture and movement.
6. Report measurable improvements in awareness, comfort, and daily habits based on pre/post questionnaires.

8 Weeks Workshop Plan

Week 1 — Introduction, Baseline Assessment & Posture Fundamentals (Sitting/Standing)

Goals: Set expectations, ensure safe participation, establish baseline data, and introduce core posture principles.

Content:

- Orientation, workshop goals, and rules of safe practice
- **Pre-workshop questionnaire** administration

- Introduction to MSK health: common pain patterns, risk factors, and **red flags** requiring medical referral
 - Correct posture for **sitting & standing**
 - Neutral spine concepts, workstation basics, load distribution
 - Practical posture corrections and **micro-break strategies**
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Week 2 — Movement Mechanics (Walking + Daily Activities) & Daily Pain Prevention

Goals: Improve movement efficiency and reduce daily strain through correct mechanics and prevention strategies.

Content:

- Correct posture for **walking & daily movement mechanics**
 - Gait basics
 - Safe bending/lifting principles
 - Stair and carrying mechanics
 - Movement efficiency and joint protection strategies
 - Preventing MSK pain during the day
 - Identifying triggers: prolonged static posture, repetitive motion, stress–tension cycle
 - Practical prevention: warm-up at work, stretching breaks, task variation
 - Self-management toolkit (early response strategies + habit integration)
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Week 3 — Sleep Ergonomics, Recovery & Nutrition for Whole-Body Health

Goals: Strengthen recovery behaviors (sleep, hydration, pacing) and connect lifestyle factors to MSK and whole-body health.

Content:

- Sleep ergonomics & recovery
 - Sleep positions (side/back) and pillow/mattress considerations
 - Recovery habits: hydration, pacing, gentle mobility routines
 - Nutrition for whole-body health
 - Balanced plate model, protein adequacy, key micronutrients (bone/muscle support), hydration
 - Nutrition and inflammation (practical guidance, not diet culture)
 - Linking nutrition to energy, recovery, and long-term health
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Week 4 — Full-Body Exercise Program, Surface Anatomy & Post Assessment + Wrap-Up

Goals: Ensure participants can safely perform a daily routine, understand key muscles, and measure progress.

Content:

- Daily exercise program (full body)
 - Mobility + strengthening routine for: neck/shoulders, spine/core, hips/knees, ankles/feet
 - Progression principles: frequency, intensity, technique, and safe modification
- Surface anatomy & key muscles
 - Surface anatomy basics
 - Posture-related muscles: core, glutes, scapular stabilizers, hip flexors, hamstrings

- **Post-workshop questionnaire** administration
- Review, practical exam/checklist, Q&A, individual action plans

Course Content and Topics Covered:

- Correct Posture for Sitting, Standing, Walking, and Sleeping
- How to Avoid MSK Pain Throughout the Day
- Importance of Healthy Nutrition for Whole-Body Health
- Daily Exercises for Different Body Regions
- Surface Anatomy of the MSK System and Key Muscles

Outcomes and Program Impact (Template)

Observed improvements (self-reported):

- Better posture habits during sitting and standing
- Increased frequency of movement breaks
- Higher adherence to daily exercise routines
- Improved awareness of sleep ergonomics
- Better understanding of nutrition's role in health and recovery

Operational outcomes:

- High engagement during practical sessions
- Increased participant interaction and Q&A over time
- Strong demand for follow-up programs or advanced modules